

Connecticut State Department of Education

DISTRICT PROFILE AND PERFORMANCE REPORT FOR SCHOOL YEAR 2023–24



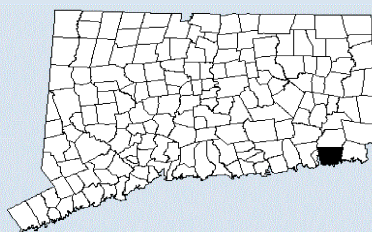
Groton School District

Susan Austin, Superintendent • 860-572-2100 • <https://www.grotonschools.org/>

District Information

Grade Range	PK-12
Number of Schools/Programs	10
Enrollment	4,099
Per Pupil Expenditures ¹	\$19,706
Total Expenditures ¹	\$87,674,091

¹ Expenditure data reflect the 2022-23 school year.



Community Information

AdvanceCT Town Profiles provide summary demographic and economic information for Connecticut's municipalities at <https://www.advancect.org/site-selection/town-profiles>

Contents

Students.....	1
Educators.....	2
Instruction and Resources.....	2
Performance and Accountability.....	4
Narratives.....	7

Notes

Unless otherwise noted, all data are for 2023-24 and include all grades offered by the district.

In most tables, data are displayed only for the three major race/ethnicity categories. For additional race/ethnicity categories, please visit <https://edsight.ct.gov>

State totals are not displayed as they are not comparable to district totals.

Special Education tables reflect only students for whom the district is fiscally responsible.

* When an asterisk is displayed, data have been suppressed to safeguard student confidentiality. Complete data suppression guidelines are available at <https://tinyurl.com/SuppressionPolicy>

N/A is displayed when a category is not applicable for a district or school.

Students

October 1, 2023 Enrollment²

	Count	District Percent of Total (%)	State Percent of Total (%)
Female	*	*	48.3
Male	2,124	51.8	51.5
Non-Binary	*	*	0.1
American Indian or Alaska Native	29	0.7	0.2
Asian	251	6.1	5.2
Black or African American	285	7.0	12.5
Hispanic or Latino of any race	1,063	25.9	31.1
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	12	0.3	0.1
Two or More Races	558	13.6	4.7
White	1,901	46.4	46.2
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	183	4.5	10.5
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	2,219	54.1	44.0
Students with Disabilities ³	806	19.7	17.9

² This table represents students in grades PK-12 reported by the district in the Public School Information System (i.e., PSIS Reporting District).

³ Students in this category are students with an individualized education program (IEP) only. This category does not include students with Section 504 plans or services plans.

Chronic Absenteeism and Suspension/Expulsion

	Chronic Absenteeism ⁴		Suspension/Expulsion ⁵	
	Count	Rate (%)	Count	Rate (%)
Female	*	*	130	6.2
Male	368	18.2	215	9.4
Non-Binary	*	*	0	*
Black or African American	71	25.8	48	15.1
Hispanic or Latino of any race	245	23.8	130	11.2
White	264	14.7	101	5.0
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	50	26.2	25	11.7
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	478	25.5	273	11.1
Students with Disabilities	196	26.3	113	11.8
District	731	18.8	345	7.9
State		17.7		7.0

Number of students qualified as truant under state statute: 1,128

Number of school-based arrests: Fewer than 6

⁴ A student is chronically absent if they miss ten percent or greater of the total number of days enrolled in the school year for any reason. Pre-Kindergarten students are excluded from this calculation.

⁵ This column displays the count and percentage of students who receive at least one in-school suspension, out-of-school suspension or expulsion.

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2023-24

Groton School District

Educators

Full-Time Equivalent (FTE)¹ Staff

	FTE
General Education	
Teachers and Instructors	286.1
Paraprofessional Instructional Assistants	72.1
Special Education	
Teachers and Instructors	63.5
Paraprofessional Instructional Assistants	161.2
Administrators, Coordinators and Department Chairs	
District Central Office	10.0
School Level	24.5
Library/Media	
Specialists (Certified)	7.5
Support Staff	2.0
Instructional Specialists Who Support Teachers	31.0
Counselors, Social Workers and School Psychologists	33.1
School Nurses	9.0
Other Staff Providing Non-Instructional Services/Support	277.9

¹ In the full-time equivalent count, staff members working part-time in the school are counted as a fraction of full-time. For example, a teacher who works half-time in a school contributes 0.50 to the school's staff count.

Educators by Race/Ethnicity

	Count	District Percent of Total (%)	State Percent of Total (%)
American Indian or Alaska Native	0	0.0	0.1
Asian	8	1.8	1.4
Black or African American	16	3.5	4.8
Hispanic or Latino of any race	16	3.5	5.1
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	0	0.0	0.1
Two or More Races	2	0.4	0.3
White	416	90.8	88.3

Classroom Teacher Attendance: 2022-23

	District	State
Average Number of FTE Days Absent Due to Illness or Personal Time	15.3	13.3

Instruction and Resources

11th and 12th Graders Enrolled in College-and-Career-Readiness Courses during High School²

	11th		12th	
	Count	Rate (%)	Count	Rate (%)
Black or African American	20	95.2	18	81.8
Hispanic or Latino of any race	52	86.7	60	89.6
White	100	96.2	124	93.9
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	8	*	*	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	113	91.1	100	91.7
Students with Disabilities	38	92.7	44	81.5
District	226	93.8	245	91.1
State		88.4		94.6

² College-and-Career-Readiness Courses include Advanced Placement®(AP), International Baccalaureate®(IB), Career and Technical Education(CTE), workplace experience and dual credit courses.

Students Who Spend 80% or Greater Time with Nondisabled Peers³

	Count	Rate (%)
Autism	57	43.8
Emotional Disability	25	43.1
Intellectual Disability	*	*
Learning Disability	235	86.1
Other Health Impairment	97	78.2
Other Disabilities	*	*
Speech/Language Impairment	75	98.7
District	503	70.1
State		66.8

³ This table represents students ages 6-21 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2023-24

Groton School District

Students with Disabilities by Primary Disability¹

	District		State
	Count	Rate (%)	Rate (%)
Autism	136	3.3	2.6
Emotional Disability	59	1.4	1.1
Intellectual Disability	30	0.7	0.6
Learning Disability	275	6.6	6.4
Other Health Impairment	126	3.0	3.5
Other Disabilities	69	1.7	1.2
Speech/Language Impairment	92	2.2	2.0
All Disabilities	787	18.9	17.3

¹ This table represents students in grades K-12 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

Students with Disabilities Placed Outside of the District²

	District		State
	Count	Rate (%)	Rate (%)
Public Schools in Other Districts	49	6.2	8.0
Private Schools or Other Settings	28	3.6	4.6

² This table represents students in grades K-12 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

Overall Expenditures³: 2022-23

	Total (\$)	Per Pupil	
		District (\$)	State (\$)
Instruction	\$47,206,274	\$10,611	\$12,942
Support services - students	\$15,496,615	\$3,797	\$1,724
Support services - instruction	\$1,930,294	\$473	\$905
Support services - general administration	\$2,744,234	\$672	\$520
Support services - school based administration	\$4,635,875	\$1,136	\$1,207
Central and other support services	\$1,791,600	\$439	\$771
Operation and maintenance of plant	\$7,136,743	\$1,749	\$2,101
Student transportation services	\$6,732,457	\$1,665	\$1,582
Food services	.	.	\$8
Enterprise operations	.	.	\$213
Total	\$87,674,091	\$19,706	\$21,143

³ Expenditures may be supported by local tax revenues, state grants, federal grants, municipal in-kind services, tuition and other sources.

Special Education Expenditures: 2022-23

	District		State
	Total (\$)	Percent of Total (%)	Percent of Total (%)
Teacher Salaries	\$10,051,708	41.3	27.6
Instructional Aide Salaries	\$3,098,658	12.7	10.2
Other Salaries	\$1,231,240	5.1	10.5
Employee Benefits	\$1,825,381	7.5	13.2
Purchased Services Other Than Transportation	\$1,659,281	6.8	6.4
Special Education Tuition	\$3,883,005	15.9	22.2
Supplies	\$167,118	0.7	0.7
Property Services	\$540	0.0	0.4
Purchased Services For Transportation	\$2,407,807	9.9	8.4
Equipment	\$27,452	0.1	0.3
All Other Expenditures	\$3,155	0.0	0.1
Total	\$24,355,345	100.0	100.0
Percent of Total Expenditures Used for Special Education		27.8	25.0

Expenditures by Revenue Source⁴: 2022-23

	Percent of Total (%) Excluding School Construction
Local	60.9
State	30.7
Federal	8.3
Tuition & Other	0.1

⁴ Revenue sources do not include state-funded Teachers' Retirement Board contributions, Connecticut Technical Education and Career System (CTECS) operations, CSDE-budgeted costs for salaries and leadership activities and other state-funded school districts (e.g., Dept. of Children and Families and Dept. of Correction).

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2023-24

Groton School District

Performance and Accountability

District Performance Index (DPI)

A District Performance Index (DPI) is the average performance of students in a subject area (i.e., ELA, Mathematics or Science) on the state summative assessments. The DPI ranges from 0-100. A DPI is reported for all students tested in a district and for students in each individual student group. Connecticut's ultimate target for a DPI is 75.

	English Language Arts (ELA)		Math		Science	
	Count	DPI	Count	DPI	Count	DPI
American Indian or Alaska Native	15	*	15	*	*	*
Asian	108	73.7	108	74.0	41	77.1
Black or African American	129	53.5	128	47.9	62	50.2
Hispanic or Latino of any race	506	58.8	504	52.5	183	52.9
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	9	*	9	*	*	*
Two or More Races	251	62.2	251	55.7	98	56.3
White	893	70.4	892	64.4	360	68.6
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	116	54.1	116	50.0	45	45.4
Non-English Learners/Non-Multilingual Learners	1,795	65.9	1,791	60.0	706	62.9
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	920	58.5	918	52.6	368	54.4
Not Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	991	71.4	989	65.7	383	69.1
Students with Disabilities	358	44.4	357	37.3	143	39.5
Students without Disabilities	1,553	70.0	1,550	64.5	608	67.1
High Needs	1,081	57.3	1,078	51.4	419	53.6
Non-High Needs	830	75.4	829	69.8	332	72.3
District	1,911	65.2	1,907	59.4	751	61.9

National Assessment of Educational Progress (NAEP): Percent At or Above Proficient¹

	NAEP 2022		NAEP 2013
	Grade 4	Grade 8	Grade 12
READING			
Connecticut	35	35	50
National Public	32	29	36
MATH			
Connecticut	37	30	32
National Public	35	26	25

¹ NAEP is often called the "Nation's Report Card." It is sponsored by the U.S. Department of Education. This table compares Connecticut's performance to that of national public school students. Performance standards for state assessments and NAEP are set independently. Therefore, one should not expect performance results to be the same across Smarter Balanced and NAEP. Instead, NAEP results are meant to complement other state assessment data. To view performance on NAEP by student group, at https://portal.ct.gov/-/media/SDE/Student-Assessment/NAEP/report-card_NAEP-2022.pdf

Physical Fitness Tests: Students Reaching Health Standard²

	Percent of Students by Grade ³ (%)				All Tested Grades	
	4	6	8	HS	Count	Rate (%)
Sit & Reach	81.2	81.1	85.0	85.7	1,062	83.0
Curl Up	74.7	82.5	83.3	87.4	1,057	81.4
Push Up	58.0	77.3	70.8	84.4	1,052	71.5
Mile Run/PACER	69.2	59.6	40.9	51.9	1,052	56.6
All Tests - District	38.6	48.6	35.4	45.6	1,039	42.0
All Tests - State	53.6	48.4	44.6	42.3		47.2

²The Connecticut Physical Fitness Assessment (CPFA) is administered to students in Grades 4, 6, 8 and High School (HS). The health-related fitness scores gathered through the CPFA should be used to educate and motivate children and their families to increase physical activity and develop lifetime fitness habits.

³Only students assessed in all four areas are included in this calculation.

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2023-24

Groton School District

Cohort Graduation: Four-Year¹

	2022-23	
	Cohort Count ²	Rate (%)
Black or African American	22	77.3
Hispanic or Latino of any race	63	74.6
White	113	92.0
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	17	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	142	78.9
Students with Disabilities	48	60.4
District	240	84.2
State		88.4

¹ The four-year cohort graduation rate represents the percentage of first-time 9th graders who earn a standard high school diploma within four years.

² Cohort count includes all students in the cohort as of the end of the 2022-23 school year.

11th and 12th Graders Demonstrating Postsecondary Readiness³

	Count	Rate (%)
Female	148	56.5
Male	*	*
Non-Binary	*	*
Black or African American	*	*
Hispanic or Latino	42	33.1
White	149	63.1
English Learners/ Multilingual Learners	0	0.0
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	77	33.0
Students with Disabilities	*	*
District	258	50.6
State		44.3

³Students demonstrate postsecondary readiness through at least one of the following:

- SAT® - meets benchmark score on SAT, Revised SAT or Connecticut School Day SAT
- ACT® - meets benchmark score on 3 of 4 exams (benchmark score varies by subject)
- AP® - 3 or higher on any one AP® exam
- IB® - 4 or higher on any one IB® exam
- Earning three or more non-remedial college credits cumulatively during high school.

Sources:

SAT® and AP® statistics derived from data provided by the College Board.

Copyright © 2024 The College Board. www.collegeboard.org

ACT® statistics derived from data provided by ACT, Inc.

Copyright © 2024 ACT, Inc. www.act.org

IB® statistics derived from data provided by the International Baccalaureate Organization.

Copyright © International Baccalaureate Organization 2024

College Entrance and Persistence

	Class of 2023	Class of 2022
	Entrance ⁵ Rate (%)	Persistence ⁶ Rate (%)
Female	60.2	84.0
Male	54.5	83.8
Non-Binary	*	N/A
Black or African American	*	*
Hispanic or Latino of any race	39.6	71.4
White	63.6	86.0
English Learners/ Multilingual Learners	*	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	47.0	75.4
Students with Disabilities	18.2	*
District	56.9	83.9
State	68.4	87.2

⁵ College entrance refers to the percent of high school graduates from the year who enrolled in college any time during the first year after high school.

⁶ College persistence refers to the percent of students who enrolled in college the first year after high school and returned for a second year (Freshman to Sophomore persistence).

Source: National Student Clearinghouse

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2023-24

Groton School District

Next Generation Accountability Results

Connecticut's Next Generation Accountability System is a broad set of 12 indicators that help tell the story of how well a district/school is preparing its students for success in college, careers, and life. It moves beyond test scores and graduation rates to provide a more holistic, multifactor perspective of district and school performance.

Indicator		Index/Rate	Target	Points Earned	Max Points	% Points Earned	State Average Index/Rate
ELA Performance Index	All Students	65.2	75	43.5	50	86.9	63.9
	High Needs Students	57.3	75	38.2	50	76.5	54.1
Math Performance Index	All Students	59.4	75	39.6	50	79.2	60.2
	High Needs Students	51.4	75	34.3	50	68.5	49.5
Science Performance Index	All Students	61.9	75	41.2	50	82.5	61.8
	High Needs Students	53.6	75	35.7	50	71.5	51.4
ELA Academic Growth	All Students	59.9%	100%	59.9	100	59.9	58.7%
	High Needs Students	58.5%	100%	58.5	100	58.5	54.2%
Math Academic Growth	All Students	56.7%	100%	56.7	100	56.7	61.4%
	High Needs Students	53.9%	100%	53.9	100	53.9	55.1%
Progress Toward English Proficiency	Literacy	57.2%	100%	28.6	50	57.2	58.9%
	Oral	58.0%	100%	29.0	50	58.0	55.2%
Chronic Absenteeism	All Students	18.8%	<=5%	22.3	50	44.6	17.7%
	High Needs Students	24.1%	<=5%	11.7	50	23.4	25.5%
Preparation for CCR	% Taking Courses	92.4%	75%	50.0	50	100.0	91.5%
	% Meeting Benchmark	50.6%	75%	33.7	50	67.5	44.3%
On-track to High School Graduation		86.3%	94%	45.9	50	91.9	84.5%
4-year Graduation All Students (2023 Cohort)		84.2%	94%	89.5	100	89.5	88.4%
6-year Graduation - High Needs Students (2021 Cohort)		81.5%	94%	86.7	100	86.7	86.6%
Postsecondary Entrance (Class of 2023)		56.9%	75%	75.9	100	75.9	68.4%
Physical Fitness (estimated part rate) and (fitness rate)		90.3% 42.0%	75%	28.0	50	56.0	93.6% 47.2%
Arts Access		63.1%	60%	50.0	50	100.0	55.0%
Accountability Index				1013.0	1450	69.9	

NOTE: A dot (.) appears in the table above when there are fewer than 20 students in the student group or the indicator is not applicable based on grades served.

Gap Indicators	Non-High Needs Rate ¹	High Needs Rate	Size of Gap	State Gap Mean +1 Stdev ²	Is Gap an Outlier? ²
Achievement Gap Size Outlier?					Y
ELA Performance Index Gap	75.0	57.3	17.7	16.9	
Math Performance Index Gap	69.8	51.4	18.4	18.2	
Science Performance Index Gap	72.3	53.6	18.7	17.9	
Graduation Rate Gap	94.0%	81.5%	12.5%	9.9%	Y

¹If the Non-High Needs Rate exceeds the ultimate target (75 for Performance Index and 94% for graduation rate), the ultimate target is used for gap calculations.

²If the size of the gap exceeds the state mean gap plus one standard deviation, the gap is an outlier.

NOTE: A dot (.) appears in the table above when there are fewer than 20 students in at least one of the student groups used to calculate the gap measure or the indicator is not applicable based on grades served. Gap calculations are based on unrounded rates.

Subject/Student Group		Participation Rate (%) ³
ELA	All Students	98.5
	High Needs Students	98.0
Math	All Students	98.3
	High Needs Students	97.7
Science	All Students	97.7
	High Needs Students	96.6

³Minimum participation standard is 95%.

Connecticut's State Identified Measurable Result (SIMR) for Children with Disabilities

Increase the reading performance of all 3rd grade students with disabilities statewide, as measured by Connecticut's English Language Arts (ELA) Performance Index.

Grade 3 ELA Performance Index for Students with Disabilities:

District: 50.4

State: 49.7

Supporting Resources: <https://public-edsight.ct.gov/Overview/Next-Generation-Accountability-Dashboard#related-links>

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2023-24

Groton School District

Narratives

School District Improvement Plans and Parental Outreach Activities

Groton Public Schools (GPS) realized the Groton 2020 plan with the opening of one new middle school, Groton Middle School, ensuring excellence and equity for all middle school students when it opened three years ago. This was part of the plan with the State of Connecticut to ensure racial and socioeconomic balance at all Groton schools, along with building two new elementary schools that were built on the sites of the former two middle schools with all five of our elementary schools becoming intra-district magnet schools for students in Groton. With this plan, all seven of our schools are now within +/- 15% of our economic/racial makeup of 51% free/reduced lunch/students of color so our schools more closely represent and mirror our community.

A continued goal for Groton Public Schools (GPS) for FY23 was to reduce chronic absenteeism related to some of the residual effects of the pandemic including COVID-19 breakthrough cases, susceptibility to other illnesses such as the flu and RSV, and heightened mental health challenges. We continue to focus on Social Emotional learning for students and adults. GPS continues our work with Responsive Classroom, Life is Good, Bibliotherapy, Restorative Practices, and Second Step. Groton continues to support the work of the Diversity, Equity, and Inclusion committee with a focus on diverse hiring practices, data analysis, and bias training. In partnership with Equal Opportunity Schools, the National Math Science Initiative (NMSI), and Cornelius Minor, the district is providing embedded coaching for all teachers and staff PK-12 that supports student access to rigorous coursework. Fitch High School has also seen many more underrepresented students taking AP/IB/ECE and Honors courses, and in some cases, doubling our numbers of students in those classes.

Continuing our good work with academics in both the Core instruction and SRBI tiered intervention model, funds are used to provide district wide curriculum review, evaluation, and professional development related to the Connecticut Core and NGSS Standards Initiative in ELA, Math, Science and Social Studies. Professional development will continue to include virtual webinar sessions to provide engaging instruction with the use of technology. By using excellent staff developers in Literacy and STEM such as Project Oceanography, CREC, and LEARN, our goal is to provide support for teaching and learning. GPS has been researching and providing professional learning in the science of reading at the elementary level and has had many teachers trained in the Wilson Program and Spire program, both aligned to the Ort-Gillingham methodology.

Efforts to Reduce Racial, Ethnic and Economic Isolation

Groton schools continues to work to ensure that our students receive an education, which enables them to interact with teachers and students from diverse racial, ethnic, and economic backgrounds.

In the spring of 2020, the Groton Board of Education initiated a district-wide Diversity, Equity, and Inclusion Committee. The DEI committee developed a five-year program to address issues of systemic racism and to promote equity for all members of the educational community. All faculty and staff were involved in the experience and the BOE recognized and approved the DEI vision statement for Groton Public Schools. The Board continues to support this initiative in the operating budget. In FY23 we launched school-based DEI groups and those representatives continue to serve on the district-wide DEI group with other educators across all buildings and central office.

Other opportunities that supported the Groton 2020 plan was launching intra-magnet school programs and career pathways; offering enriching and diverse experience for our student population included student trips to the Mystic Seaport, the Mystic Aquarium, Project Oceanology, NESS, The Mystic Art Museum, the Eastern Connecticut Symphony Orchestra, The Nautilus Museum, to name a few, as well as our continued partnering with the U.S. Naval Submarine Base and use of its resources.

Fitch High School students participated remotely in a regional diversity program called More Than Words. The program engages students from New London High School, Ledyard High School and students from the Mashantucket Pequot Tribal Nation in a year-long workshop designed to promote respect for diversity and develop skills in conflict resolution.

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2023-24

Groton School District

Equitable Allocation of Resources among District Schools

The Groton Board of Education's policy concerning the annual distribution of resources ensures that each of the seven schools in the district receives an adequate level of material, supplies, and personnel to implement and execute educational programs. Funding is based on student enrollment, district-wide educational programs, and the unique needs of its students, commensurate with district goals and available resources to ensure equity and address needs. Groton Public Schools addresses equity concerns and outreach so that all students and families have access and benefit from these programs. The district will ensure that barriers, such as gender, race, national origin, color, disability, age, socio-economics or others, will not prevent students, families, teachers, and staff from access or participation in these programs: Support engaging instruction; provide effective assessments that assist a teacher in monitoring student achievement while informing his/her instruction; Raise the rigor and relevance of instruction, especially using tenets of culturally relevant and responsive pedagogy; Lay the foundation for Access and Equity through International Baccalaureate programming.